Itang Rakhongli

Song Identifier: SNG-TRAD-008

English Translation: Song of the Riverbank and Beloved Hills

Song Type: love_song | Dialect: Hunphun / Standard Tangkhul

Singer/Performers: Traditional Tangkhul Troupe | Village: Hunphun

Collector/Documentation: Tangkhul Literature Society / Traditional Elders

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Cultural Significance & Notes:

Classic Tangkhul lyrical love song expressing yearning across mountain ranges, invoking the hills to lower their peaks that one may gaze upon beloved homeland.

Lyrics & Stanzas (Tangkhul & English Translation):

[Stanza 1]

Tangkhul Verses:

"Itang rakhongli, Ayisho yaota rarali,"

"Ayisho, yaota rarali."

"Kongrei khanganu wui ngaloong pamei,"

"I-wui ningli leikashi thot leisai."

English Gloss:

"Along the riverbanks of our village, gazing far into the distant hills,"

"O beloved, looking far across the valleys."

"Beside the clear murmuring waters and sacred ancient stones,"

"In my heart, the deepest love of our youth abides."

[Stanza 2]

Tangkhul Verses:

"Imak oh khavamkhui milu,"

"Imak oh mavamkhui thu-a."

"Leikashi kaphung kanhaira,"

"Kaphungchi khanemta milu."

English Gloss:

"O mother, let not our tearful eyes be dimmed by distance,"

"Let not sorrow cloud the vision of our eyes."

"The beloved mountain ridge rises tall between us,"

"O gentle peaks, lower yourselves down that I may gaze upon my love!"

[Stanza 3]

Tangkhul Verses:

"Leikashi ram ngashanvaika,"

"Iram Hunphun wui won kapha."

"Ningkachang wui tui khamata,"

"Thot kachungli mashimanmana."

English Gloss:

"That our eyes may catch a glimpse of our beloved homeland,"

"The fairest blossom blooming on the slopes of Hunphun."

"The sacred promise whispered in mutual longing,"

"Shall never perish through the passing of generations."